



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from Lebanon. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish.

What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing that! It's great that you've finished primary school and are now thinking carefully about your next steps — that shows maturity. Since you're in Denmark, your options after **9th or 10th grade** (depending on what you finished) mainly fall into **three broad paths**, and the best choice depends on your **interests, strengths, and career goals**.

1. Gymnasiale Uddannelser (Upper Secondary General Education)

This is for you if you think you might want to go to **university** later.

There are a few types:

- **STX (Almen studentereksamen)** – General upper secondary education, with strong academic focus (math, science, literature, etc.)
- **HHX (Højere handelseksamen)** – Business-oriented, focused on economics, international trade, and marketing.
- **HTX (Højere teknisk eksamen)** – Technical upper secondary, great if you like **technology, science, and innovation**.
- **HF (Højere forberedelseksamen)** – A 2-year alternative, more practice-oriented and for those who maybe didn't thrive academically in primary school.

Choose this path if:

- You like academic subjects and want to keep many doors open.
- You're interested in going to university or a professional bachelor's degree.
- You enjoy school and want more theory-based learning.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training / EUD)

This is a more hands-on path that prepares you for specific jobs (e.g. electrician, carpenter, mechanic, hairdresser, chef, etc.).

- Usually includes a mix of school and apprenticeship (praktik).
- Can be a faster route to the job market.
- You can still access higher education later, especially if you take **EUX** (a combined vocational + academic path).

Choose this path if:

- You prefer practical learning.

- You want to start working earlier.
- You're interested in a skilled trade or craft.

3. 10th Grade / Efterskole / Boarding Options

If you're unsure, you can choose:

- **10th grade** – A year to improve academically, mature a bit more, or focus on certain subjects.
- **Efterskole** – A unique Danish school where you live for a year, often with focus on personal development, social skills, and specialized subjects (sports, music, arts, etc.).

Choose this path if:

- You're not ready to commit to a long-term direction.
- You want to grow socially and personally.
- You want to explore your interests more before making a decision.

Considering your background:

- Being fluent in Danish is a huge advantage. Use it!
- If your parents are immigrants, you may also have access to **extra support** or **mentorship programs** (e.g., *brobygning*, youth programs, study cafes).
- Don't hesitate to talk to your **school counselor** (*uddannelsesvejleder*) — they're experienced in guiding students exactly like you.

How to decide?

Here are three simple questions to ask yourself:

1. **Do I enjoy learning in a classroom, or prefer doing things with my hands?**
2. **Do I want to go to university someday, or start working earlier?**
3. **What subjects or activities do I really enjoy or feel good at?**

If you want, I can help you explore some **career ideas** or even recommend paths based on your **hobbies or skills**. Just tell me more about what you enjoy doing!

Would you like help figuring that out?